



MS NOW correspondent Vaughn Hillyard addresses viewers from a spot near the White House on Monday.

Lawsuit over White House access

Networks back CNN, MS NOW, Politico after Trump ban for unfavorable coverage.

By Stephen Battaglio

Deepening the news media's clashes with President Trump, CNN, MS NOW and Politico are headed to court to challenge the constitutionality of the president's order to ban the three news organizations from the White House.

The three outlets filed a lawsuit Monday in U.S. District Court in Washington asking for a temporary restraining order that restores their access immediately while the case is heard.

"This morning we notified the government that we are filing a lawsuit today to protect our First Amendment rights and defend the principle that the government does not decide what the press reports and publishes," CNN, MS NOW and Politico said in a statement. "Without notice or due process, the White House revoked our journalists' credentials because it objected to our reporting. Left unchallenged this threatens press freedom and the public's right to independent journalism free from government interference."

The ban has already raised questions on how the news media and the public will be able to monitor the president's activities. CNN was scheduled to provide the video feed of Trump's Monday trip to New York for the United Nations General Assembly. The pool feed, as it's called, provides video to all other media outlets.

The other networks in the pool — CBS, NBC, ABC and Fox News — stood in solidarity with CNN and did not [See News, A6]

Frustrated on many fronts, aiming for control

Trump focuses on Greenland, 'A.I. Force,' Iran and media ban ahead of diplomatic meetings

By Ana Ceballos

WASHINGTON — President Trump on Monday headed into a week full of high-stakes meetings with world leaders after spending a 72-hour period banning reporters from the White House, mulling whether it was time to "blow ... up" Iran, and proposing to host military drones and snipers at his triumphal arch in the nation's capital.

The weekend — which also included the announcement of a security deal over Greenland and the creation of a new "A.I. Force" — captured an American president operating unpredictably across multiple fronts even as each one drew friction. The actions now stand to color the backdrop of a week that will feature meetings with world leaders at the United Nations General Assembly in New York and a state visit by Chinese President Xi Jinping in Washington.

Each of those moves carries its own political weight ahead of the diplomatic talks, but also ahead of the midterm elections, where these topics are front and center in key races.

Trump's handling of the Iran war, its

subsequent shocks to the global economy, his push to fast-track the development of artificial intelligence and the Greenland agreement are likely to come up in meetings with world leaders. His deal with Denmark to bolster the U.S. military presence in Greenland, a territory Trump has repeatedly tried to annex, is expected to be signed Tuesday in New York, though action is still needed by the Danish and Greenland governments before it can be enforced.

Although all the details of the Greenland deal are not public yet, Trump has said it is a "dream come true for the United States of America."

"This solution is a great one for the United States of America, Denmark, Greenland and all of our Allies," Trump wrote on social media Friday. "We look forward to working with the wonderful people of Denmark and Greenland toward a magnificent future with respect to this large, and highly strategic, parcel of land. We will be very protective of it."

In an inter- [See Trump, A6]

Newsom sounds alarm on El Niño

Emergency declared as forecasters warn of punishing storm season

By Grace Toohey



Allen J. Schaben Los Angeles Times

Brenda Porter with her daughter Isabel in Carlsbad, which is under a local state of emergency.

Gov. Gavin Newsom has declared a statewide emergency for California in anticipation of El Niño-charged storms this fall and winter, the latest sign of growing concern about the chance for more flooding, coastal erosion and strong waves in the coming months.

The intensifying El Niño climate pattern is likely to fuel several strong storms that could hit California with heavy rainfall, strong winds, mountain snow and high waves, causing flooding, landslides, debris flows, coastal damage and power outages, the governor's office warned Monday. The emergency declaration will help coordinate and mobilize supplies and work across the state, including flood mitigation and shoreline protection.

The possibility of this extreme weather "warrants early, coordinated, and targeted preparedness actions to protect Californians, critical infrastructure, agricultural lands, natural resources, and the State's [See Emergency, A7]

Paramount, 12 states reach merger deal

California and others agree to end antitrust lawsuit over Warner Bros. purchase.

By Meg James and Samantha Masunaga

California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta and Paramount Skydance Chief Executive David Ellison have reached an agreement to end the state's antitrust fight, paving the way for Ellison to complete his \$13-billion purchase of Warner Bros. Discovery, Bonta and Paramount confirmed Monday.

The two sides have agreed to resolve antitrust claims that Bonta and 11 other state attorneys general brought in late July. The agreement covers five years and is court-enforceable, Bonta's office said.

As part of the deal, Paramount agreed to pay a penalty and to divest the Miramax film studio if the company fails to make good on a promise to distribute 30 films per year in theaters for the first two years of the combined company, and 32 films per year for the three years after that.

Paramount also pledged to spend \$300 million more each year on film production in the U.S. and further boost its film spending if the federal government adopts a film tax credit of at least 20%.

Key points of the pact

To resolve antitrust claims and complete the Paramount-Warner Bros. Discovery merger, Paramount agreed to:

- Distribute 30 films per year in theaters for two years under the combined company and 32 films per year for the next three years after that.
- Spend at least \$1.5 billion on film production in the U.S. over the next five years.
- Establish a board to ensure editorial independence for CNN and CBS News.
- Pay a penalty and divest Miramax if the company does not meet its film distribution requirements.

The studio also pledged not to sell or close its Melrose Avenue lot or Warner Bros.' Burbank lot and to operate them "in a manner consistent with past practices," according to the consent decree.

Additionally, the settlement includes a requirement for Paramount to establish a board to ensure editorial independence for CNN and CBS News, though it was not clear how the board would be able to enforce its recommendations.

The agreement fell short [See Settlement, A10]

A struggle to secure Games transit funds

Metro gets just a sliver of what it sought from the state Legislature for Olympics projects.

By James Rainey and Justine McDaniel

Los Angeles officials have long complained that the Trump administration hasn't done enough to prioritize transportation funding for the 2028 Summer Olympics in the deep-blue metropolis, but Democratic Gov. Gavin Newsom and the Democrat-dominated state Legislature are turning out to be just as tight with a buck.

Sacramento has rejected the vast majority of transportation funding requests linked to the 2028 Olympics — a situation that leaves L.A. Metro, the giant transit agency, in an unexpected po-

sition: struggling as much with Sacramento as with the Republican-controlled White House and Congress when it comes to financial support to move athletes and visitors during an Olympics that is now just 22 months away.

Metro asked for \$379 million for Olympics-related transportation projects in the just-completed legislative session. It got only \$20 million.

Among the requests for state money that lawmakers rejected:

■ \$138 million for a cloud-based computing system, traffic cameras and video connectivity to help expand and integrate transportation management systems controlled by Caltrans and the Los Angeles City Department of Transportation.

■ \$65 million for installing emergency tracks where [See Olympics, A5]

His mighty goal: Grow 10,000 oak trees



Sandy Huffaker For The Times

Jim Crouch visits a San Diego County park full of oaks. His group is opening a nursery to help Altadena.

Retired teacher brings his years-long passion project and acorns to fire-racked Altadena.

By Jessie Schiewe

Ten thousand times, Jim Crouch has picked up an acorn. Ten thousand times, he's planted that acorn. And 10,000 is about the number of oak seedlings he's entrusted to the hands of people who pledged to care for the tree that has become his mission and obsession.

It began after he retired. For years, he'd been a classroom science teacher in suburban San Diego County, and now, with that chapter behind him, the trees have become his life. He hopes to meaningfully contribute to the regrowth of burned Altadena.

California has Thousand Oaks, Sherman Oaks, Oak Park, Fair Oaks, even Oakland. That's just in English. Consider Encino, Encinitas and Paso Robles. They paint a picture of a California covered in oaks. But many regions have lost their oak [See Oaks, A7]



Ronaldo Bolaños Los Angeles Times

PRIZE PROSPECT

The Dodgers' Josue De Paula earned a call-up with his bat, and now he's looking to develop his defensive skills to stay in the majors. **SPORTS, B10**

Five races could help flip Senate

Democrats are doing better than expected in polls in key states, but many voters are still undecided. **NATION, A4**

Weather

Clouds, then sun. L.A. Basin: 80/65. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**

New state laws for data centers

Newsom signs seven bills that will regulate the growing industry. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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